



YUSUF OLAWALE OGUNTOLA

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Innovative and impact-driven technology leader with over a decade of experience in technology leadership and business strategy. A proven track record of driving digital transformation and fostering innovation in complex environments. Skilled in building and leading high-performing teams to deliver groundbreaking solutions. Recognized for expertise in software engineering, strategic business management, and effective communication. Committed to driving technological advancement and positive change in Africa and beyond.

KEY QUALIFICATIONS

- Digital Transformation
- Team Building & Leadership
- Infrastructure Innovation
- Technology Leadership
- Financial Inclusion
- Software Engineering Expertise
- Strategic Business Management
- Effective Communication
- Team Building

SOFTWARE ENGINEERING SKILLS

- Python
- Java (SE, FX, EE)
- Javascript
- Django
- C# MVC
- Version Control (Hg, Git)
- ReactJs
- Sharepoint Dev. (From SP2010)
- System Architecture & Management

EXPERIENCE

Chief Technology Officer

May 2021 - Present

AFEX Commodities Exchange Limited | Abuja, Nigeria

Technical Leadership and Team Management

- **Team Building and Leadership:** Initiated and led the development of a high-performing engineering team, scaling it from three members to over sixty engineers across various disciplines, including software engineering, product management, data analysis, machine learning, DevOps, product design, security, and technical support.

- **Strategic Technology Leadership:** Served as the Chief Technology Officer, overseeing the entire technology stack and driving the company's technological vision and strategy.
- **Cross-Functional Collaboration:** Collaborated effectively with diverse stakeholders, including government officials, board members, senior management, equity investors, and external partners.

Product Development and Innovation

- **Innovative Solutions:** Pioneered the development of a cutting-edge digital agriculture security trading platform, enabling secure and efficient trading for a wide range of investors. Additionally, led the development of:
 - **Cudie:** A financial mobile wallet system designed to empower rural farmers and similar users by providing access to banking services and financial management tools.
 - **Sherlock:** A powerful natural language query and interaction tool, leveraging LlamaIndex and GPT-3.5 Turbo to convert complex data into actionable insights through charts and dashboards.
- **Global Impact:** Spearheaded the creation of a world-first 24/7 exchange engine, revolutionizing the industry and garnering industry recognition.

Operational Excellence and Scalability

- **Global Expansion:** Successfully expanded operations to four African countries, ensuring seamless and efficient technology solutions across diverse markets.
- **Government Partnerships:** Collaborated with the Nigerian federal government to develop and deploy a subsidy program management system, focusing on farmer management, process optimization, and reporting.
- **Strategic Partnerships:** Negotiated and closed a significant sale contract with the Kenyan government for the exchange platform, and currently overseeing similar projects in a few other African countries.

Business Technology Lead

AFEX Commodities Exchange Limited | Abuja, Nigeria

October 2019 - May

2021

Technical Expertise and Project Delivery

- **Innovative Solutions:** Contributed to the development and successful launch of ComX, Nigeria's first public-facing agricultural commodity exchange system, recognized with the prestigious AppsAfrica Award in Agritech & FoodTech.
- **ERP Implementation:** Supervised and participated in the implementation of Workbench 3.0, a sophisticated SAAS ERP solution tailored for agricultural aggregation and trading organizations.

- **Quality Assurance and Security:** Ensured product excellence through rigorous code reviews, quality assurance testing, and security audits. Implemented recommendations to enhance system security and reliability.

Team Leadership and Talent Development

- **Talent Acquisition and Development:** Recruited and trained a skilled team of software developers, including mobile, backend, and frontend engineers, as well as quality assurance specialists to meet project demands.
- **Resource Management:** Effectively managed budgets and tracked time to optimize resource allocation and achieve project milestones.

Software Developer (Contract)

September 2018 - October

AFEX Commodities Exchange Limited | Abuja, Nigeria

2019

- Developed workbench desktop – An application for managing commodities aggregation, farmers, input loans and Payment and works both offline and online.
- Product managed the development and deployment process for Workbench (Web, API, Mobile & Desktop)

SharePoint Developer

July 2017 - December

Oando PLC | Lagos, Nigeria

2018

- **Strategic Leadership:** As the sole solution architect, established a forward-thinking software development strategy that extended beyond process automation to explore innovative solutions and unlock new business opportunities.
- **Versatile Development Skills:** Demonstrated proficiency in multiple programming languages and seamlessly integrated various tools to deliver robust and efficient software solutions.
- **Operational Excellence:** Implemented a reliable and resilient software infrastructure, as evidenced by the uninterrupted performance and minimal bug reports from the subsequent engineering team.
- **Data-Driven Insights:** Developed comprehensive analytics dashboards by leveraging Oracle web services to extract and visualize critical data, empowering informed decision-making.
- **Quality Assurance and Testing:** Rigorously tested software solutions against user requirements and development standards, ensuring optimal performance and functionality.
- **SharePoint Solutions:** Successfully designed and deployed multiple SharePoint solutions to streamline workflows and enhance collaboration across various departments.
- **Intranet and Portal Development:** Built a cutting-edge intranet portal and an asset management portal to improve internal communication and knowledge sharing. Additionally, created a user-friendly desktop widget that delivered targeted updates to senior executives in a visually appealing dashboard format.
- **Recognition:** Received the Best Employee of the Year award, acknowledging outstanding contributions to the organization.

Software Developer - Graduate Intern

December 2016 - June

SilverEdge Projects | Lagos, Nigeria

2017

- Worked on a solution for tracking aircrafts within West Africa using Raspberry Pi and Python.
- Played a lead role in software analysis and worked as part of a development team using .net Web API, AngularJS as well as software testing processes.

Lead Software Developer (Contract)

May 2015 - December

GANF Technologies | Osogbo, Nigeria

2016

- Developed applications using Python, Django And native Android.
- Supervised development teams and managed product developments from inception to deployment.

Software Developer Intern

December 2014 - February

Evince Nigeria Limited | Lagos, Nigeria

2015

- Developed Software solutions using .net SharePoint, and worked as part of the development and deployment team of TBills Application for FirstBank Nig PLC.
- Wrote Unit Tests using NUnit on a solution for a leading Bank in Nigeria and a couple of other .net applications

Programming Instructor (Contract)

May 2014 - July

Ogun State ICT (Gateway ICT) | Abeokuta, Nigeria

2014

- Trained students on JAVA SE

EDUCATION

Stanford LEAD Professional Certificate

Sep, 2023

Stanford University, Graduate School Of Business

Stanford LEAD Program.

Certificate of Completion

June 2021

Stanford University, Graduate School Of Business

Powering Digital Value Chains

BTech

December

Ladoke Akintola University of Technology, Ogbomoso, Nigeria

2015

First Class, Computer Science & Engineering

AWARDS

- Best staff of the year 2017 (SINET Technologies) - 29th Dec 2017
- Best graduating student Department of Computer Science and Engineering LAUTECH 2014/2015 graduation set. (22nd April, 2016)
- Etisalat Merit Award for Excellence in LAUTECH. (5th December, 2012)